



Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Founders Classical Academy: Corinth Upper
School Website: <https://responsiveed.com/campus/founders-corinth-7-12/>

January 6, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

SCL MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because SCL requires adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Founders Classical Academy Corinth Upper (Corinth, TX 76210 area; associated with the ResponsiveEd Founders network) presents a distinctly classical program in its public materials, anchored by virtue, a knowledge-rich curriculum, and engagement with great books and classical languages. The public materials emphasize formation of character, virtue, and civic-mindedness, along with a curriculum centered on the liberal arts (notably Latin and literature rooted in primary sources and Great Books). However, explicit religious/metaphysical foundations (theology, liturgy, sacred practice) are not foregrounded in the public materials, and some aspects of classical pedagogy (e.g., explicit Socratic seminars, formal "living curriculum" faculty identity, and explicit parent-co-teacher structures) are not clearly stated. Taken together, the school demonstrates substantial classical alignment, but with some gaps that prevent a full CLASSICAL rating across all six categories. The overall classification is SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Key signals from the school's public materials include: - The Distinctives emphasize virtue development, inquiry, explicit grammar instruction, and a knowledge-rich curriculum, with Latin integral to the program and Great Books/high-level literature anchored in primary sources. This supports Categories 2 (Purpose and Goal) and 3 (Curriculum) as CLASSICAL, and Element 4 (Pedagogy) as SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL due to partial alignment with Socratic/seminar-style practices, which are not explicitly spelled out in the public content. Evidence: Founders Classical Academy Corinth Upper materials (upper campus details, Latin, Great Books, grammar emphasis) and the Distinctives text. See: upper-campus details and Distinctives text in the crawl materials. - The explicit religious/theological foundations are not foregrounded in the available public materials; there is a strong emphasis on virtue, liberty, and the American-founders framing rather than liturgical or doctrinal content. This suggests Element 1 would be NOT CLASSICAL in the public framing. Evidence: An American Classical Education and Distinctives texts emphasize virtue, inquiry, and classical rigor without explicit theology or liturgy in the public-facing materials. - The "parents and community" dimension is not strongly foregrounded in the public materials provided here, making Element 6 less clearly CLASSICAL. Evidence: the materials emphasize institutional pedagogical aims and student formation, but lack explicit statements about parent partnership as co-teachers or broad parent formation programs on the campus site.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- **Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — NOT CLASSICAL** Evidence: Public materials foreground virtue, liberty, and a classical mission rather than explicit transcendental religious metaphysics, theology, liturgy, or sacramental practices. Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive indicators include virtue, civility, and moral formation. No explicit transcendental moral realism, theology, liturgy, or worship terms appear in the public-facing materials. Negative indicators: absence of theology, liturgy, and sacred practices in public copy. Why this rating: The rubric's religious/metaphysical criteria rely on explicit theological or liturgical framing; the site emphasizes virtue and classical

knowledge but not explicit religious metaphysics. This yields NOT CLASSICAL for Element 1.

- Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL Evidence: Text emphasizes virtue, formation, and the pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty in a classical framing; objectives include forming virtuous, well-educated citizens; the mission mentions pursuing knowledge, promoting virtue, and preparing students for a free society. Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include virtue, formation, knowledge, true/good/beautiful (implicit in “pursues knowledge, promotes virtue,” and “well-rounded, distinctively classical”). Negative signals (e.g., workforce-centered goals) are not present in the public materials. Why this rating: The materials align with the classical aim of education as formation and the pursuit of virtue and wisdom rather than mere job preparation. CLASSICAL category supported.
- Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL Evidence: Curriculum signals include Great Books/Literature rooted in primary sources, Latin as integral, grammar-focused literacy, and a knowledge-rich curriculum. These are core components of classical curricular thinking. Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include Great Books, primary sources, Latin, grammar, literature, liberal arts, knowledge-rich curriculum. Negative signals (e.g., social-studies-centric framing or project-driven emphasis replacing history) are not present in the materials. Why this rating: The presence of Great Books, Latin, and explicit grammar emphasis, with a focus on primary sources, supports a CLASSICAL curriculum designation.
- Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL Evidence: The Distinctives mention “spirit of inquiry,” virtue development, and explicit grammar/phonics instruction; the materials emphasize inquiry and classical aims but do not clearly spell out explicit Socratic seminars, regular memory work, or routine chanting in upper grades. The public materials mention inquiry and classical methods but lack explicit Socratic dialogue/seminars in the publicly stated pedagogy. Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive indicators include spirit of inquiry, memory-based practices implicit in “grammar/phonics” and primary-source literature; negative indicators: absence of explicit Socratic seminars, regular memory work, or chant-based pedagogy in the public copy. The lexicon highlights Socratic, memory work, and chant as positive pedagogical signals; those are not explicitly evidenced in the Corinth Upper public materials. Why this rating: Partial alignment with classical pedagogy (inquiry, Great Books, classical literacy) but not explicit, repeated evidence of Socratic or chant/narration-dominated pedagogy in the public materials. Therefore SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.
- Element 5: School Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL Evidence: Public materials describe a strong mission and the faculty as part of a virtuous, knowledge-rich program, with the living curriculum notion embedded in classical aims; however, explicit statements about faculty as “the living curriculum” or “model teachers” or a formal faculty portrait are not clearly shown in the available public content. Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive indicators include virtue, living curriculum (implied by classical aims), and knowledgeable faculty expectations; negative indicators: absence of explicit “faculty portrait,” formal living-curriculum language, or a detailed faculty-as-core-element statement in public copy. Why this rating: There is clear alignment with classical aims (virtue, knowledge, Great Books, etc.), but explicit, campus-level statements about faculty identity as the living curriculum or portraits of teacher/student archetypes are not clearly present in the public materials available here. Hence SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.
- Element 6: Parents & Community — NOT CLASSICAL Evidence: The publicly surfaced materials emphasize campus-level aims and student formation; there is no strong articulation of parent-as-co-teachers, parent formation programs, or open-visit policies in the accessible public copy. Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords would include “partnership with parents,” “parents as co-teachers,” “parent formation,” and broad open-visit policies; these explicit signals are not evident in the accessible public content. Negative signals: absence of explicit parent-education programs or family liturgy alignment. Why this rating: Without explicit statements about parents as co-teachers or formal parent-formation initiatives, the public materials do not strongly affirm Element 6 as CLASSICAL.

Aggregate Ranking - Overall, the school shows substantial CLASSICAL alignment in Curriculum (Element 3) and strong Classical aims in Purpose/Goal (Element 2), with notable but partial alignment in Pedagogy

(Element 4) and Faculty (Element 5. Somewhat Classical). Categories 1 (Religious and Metaphysical Foundations) and 6 (Parents & Community) yield NOT CLASSICAL signals in the public materials. Taken together, the aggregate classification is SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

What would move the needle (for SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL) - Add explicit Socratic pedagogy: Publish clear statements and examples of Socratic discussions/seminars in upper grades, with teacher-led seminars and student-led debates that align with the Great Books approach. - Flesh out the living curriculum: Publish explicit language describing the faculty as the “living curriculum,” including portraits or profiles of ideal teacher-student models and ongoing faculty development in classical pedagogy. - Strengthen parent formation and partnership: Include explicit statements about parents as co-teachers, parent book studies, family liturgy alignment, and open campus policies so that parents are clearly integrated in the classical formation process. - Elevate explicit religious/metaphysical framing (if desired by school leadership): If the school intends a stronger religious dimension, publish explicit theology, liturgy, and communal religious practices or clearly articulate a non-religious but transcendent moral framework that aligns with transcendental moral realism. - Ensure full triad coverage in Curriculum: If possible, articulate explicit inclusion of grammar, logic, and rhetoric as a visible triad across K–12, with examples of logic and rhetoric integration in upper grades and evidence of grammar instruction across levels.

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY — CATEGORY-BY-CATEGORY SNAPSHOT

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — NOT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials emphasize virtue, freedom, and a classical mission rather than theology, liturgy, or explicit transcendental metaphysical foundations.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators present: virtue; civility; moral formation. - Negative indicators: theology, liturgy, worship, sacred practice terms are not present in the accessible public content.

Why this rating - The category requires explicit transcendent or liturgical framing; the available Corinth Upper public materials do not foreground theology or liturgical worship, limiting this category to NOT CLASSICAL.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Wording emphasizes formation, virtue, wisdom, and the pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty as real; mission aims at virtue and human flourishing, with a classical mission and a focus on liberty.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: virtue, formation, knowledge, pursuit of truth/ goodness/beauty (implied), liberal/ classical mission, liberty. - Negative keywords present: None explicitly contradicting formation-focused aims.

Why this rating - The school’s stated aims align with classical education’s telos (formation of virtue and wisdom) more than with purely job-prep or information-transfer models, supporting CLASSICAL for Element 2.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Curriculum signals include Great Books; primary sources; literature rooted in Great Books; Latin as integral; explicit grammar instruction and phonics emphasis.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Great Books, primary sources, Latin, grammar, literature, liberal arts, knowledge-rich curriculum. - Negative keywords present: None evident in public copy.

Why this rating - The public materials clearly foreground the core classical-curriculum elements (Great Books, Latin, primary sources, grammar emphasis), justifying CLASSICAL for Element 3.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Positive signals include “spirit of inquiry” and a classical aim; explicit Socratic/seminar pedagogy is not clearly described in the public copy.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: spirit of inquiry; inquiry-based learning; classical aims. - Negative indicators: absence of explicit, repeated mention of Socratic seminars, chanting, or formal memory work in public copy.

Why this rating - While inquiry and classical aims are present, the explicit, widely-recognized Pedagogy signals (Socratic seminars, dialectic, memory work, chanting) are not clearly evidenced in the public materials, yielding SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Element 5: School Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials describe virtuous aims and the possibility of a living curriculum alignment; however, explicit language about faculty as the living curriculum or a formal teacher portrait is not clearly presented.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: virtue, teacher-as-virtue-model potential; knowledge-rich aims. - Negative indicators: absence of explicit “living curriculum portrait,” formal faculty-profile language, or faculty-culture statements.

Why this rating - The classical aim is present, but explicit faculty-centered descriptors are not clearly evidenced in public copy, producing a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating.

Element 6: School Parents & Community — NOT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials do not prominently feature parent-as-co-teacher, parent-education offerings, or open visitation language.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive signals would include terms like “parents as co-teachers,” “parent formation,” “open campus,” but these are not evident in the accessible public copy. - Negative indicators: absence of explicit parent-partnership language.

Why this rating - Without clear parent-partnership language or parent-education initiatives, Element 6 aligns with NOT CLASSICAL in the public materials.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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